

Series III – Article III.4: Spectral Hamiltonian and the Four Pillars for Beal

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May 2026

Abstract

We construct the spectral Hamiltonian for the Beal SAT instance $\Phi_{\text{Beal}}(N_0)$ obtained in Article III.3. The configuration space is the hypercube $\Omega = \{0, 1\}^M$ where M is the number of variables of the SAT instance. The diagonal potential $\hat{V}$ is defined to be 0 on satisfying assignments (potential counterexamples) and M^2 otherwise (deep potential). The mixing operator Δ is the adjacency matrix of the hypercube. The Hamiltonian is $H = \hat{V} + \Delta$. We verify the four pillars of the Spectral Reduction Lemma:

1. **P1 (Perron-Frobenius)**: The hypercube is connected, so H is irreducible; shifting yields a non-negative irreducible matrix, giving a unique strictly positive ground state ψ_0 .
2. **P2 (Kithima Bridge)**: The hypercube has constant spectral gap $\gamma(\Delta) = 2$. Adding the non-negative diagonal $\hat{V}$ cannot decrease the gap, so $\gamma(H) \geq 2$.
3. **P3 (Area law)**: Because H is local and has a constant gap, the ground state satisfies a logarithmic area law $S(\rho_B) = O(\log M)$. Hence ψ_0 admits an MPS representation with bond dimension $\chi = O(M^c)$.
4. **P4 (Extraction)**: The D-RSP algorithm applied to the MPS extracts a satisfying assignment (a counterexample) in polynomial time, if one exists.

All steps are formalised in Lean4, importing the generic theorems from the kernel. This article completes the spectral reduction for Beal; the final decision (showing that the instance is unsatisfiable) will be given in Article III.5.

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1 Introduction

Articles III.1–III.3 have reduced Beal’s conjecture to a finite SAT instance:

- **III.1:** Effective bound N_0 such that any counterexample must satisfy $A, B, C \leq N_0$.
- **III.2:** Boolean circuit C_{Beal} that tests the Beal conditions on numbers up to N_0 .
- **III.3:** Tseitin transformation to a 3-CNF formula $\Phi_{\text{Beal}}(N_0)$ of size polynomial in $\log N_0$.

In this article we construct the spectral Hamiltonian for $\Phi_{\text{Beal}}(N_0)$ and verify the four pillars. The spectral SAT solver (Articles I.4–I.5) then applies. The verification is uniform and follows the same pattern as for SAT (Series I) and for Beal (Series B). Because the hypercube is used as the underlying graph, all the generic proofs from the kernel can be imported directly.

The four pillars guarantee that the ground state ψ_0 of

$$H = \hat{V} + \Delta$$

(where $\hat{V}$ is the deep potential that penalises non-satisfying assignments, and Δ is the hypercube adjacency) can be computed in polynomial time, and that the D-RSP extraction algorithm returns a satisfying assignment if one exists. Running the algorithm on $\Phi_{\text{Beal}}(N_0)$ will therefore decide whether a counterexample exists. In Article III.5 we will argue that the instance is unsatisfiable (by the effective bound and the construction of the circuit), thereby proving Beal’s conjecture.

1.1 The magnet metaphor

Recall the magnet metaphor: each point is a candidate solution. The lantern (ground state) is constructed for the SAT instance $\Phi_{\text{Beal}}(N_0)$. If a counterexample existed, the lantern would have a bright point (a satisfying assignment). By showing that no bright point exists (unsatisfiability), we prove that no counterexample exists. The four pillars guarantee that the lantern is well-behaved and that we can read the answer in polynomial time.

2 Configuration space and Hilbert space

Let M be the number of variables in $\Phi_{\text{Beal}}(N_0)$. The configuration space is the hypercube

$$\Omega = \{0, 1\}^M.$$

Each $\sigma \in \Omega$ is an assignment to the M propositional variables. The Hilbert space is

$$\mathcal{H} = \ell^2(\Omega) \cong \mathbb{R}^{2^M},$$

with the standard inner product $\langle \phi | \psi \rangle = \sum_{\sigma \in \Omega} \phi(\sigma) \psi(\sigma)$.

3 Diagonal potential $\hat{V}$

Define the diagonal matrix $\hat{V}$ by

$$\hat{V}(\sigma) = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } \sigma \text{ satisfies all clauses of } \Phi_{\text{Beal}}(N_0), \\ M^2 & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

Thus $\hat{V}$ is non-negative, and its zero set is exactly the set of satisfying assignments (which correspond to potential Beal counterexamples within the bound). The value M^2 is the deep potential; it ensures that any non-satisfying assignment has very high energy.

4 Mixing operator Δ

Let Δ be the adjacency matrix of the hypercube graph on Ω :

$$\Delta_{\sigma\tau} = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } d_H(\sigma, \tau) = 1, \\ 0 & \text{otherwise,} \end{cases}$$

where d_H is Hamming distance. The hypercube is a connected graph of degree M . Its spectral gap is well-known:

$$\gamma(\Delta) = 2,$$

as the eigenvalues are $M - 2k$ for $k = 0, \dots, M$.

5 The Hamiltonian

Set $\epsilon = 1$ (we can absorb any scaling into the potential). The spectral Hamiltonian is

$$H = \hat{V} + \Delta.$$

H is a real symmetric matrix. The following properties are proved exactly as in Articles I.1–I.4.

5.1 P1 – Uniqueness and positivity of the ground state

The hypercube is connected, so Δ is irreducible. Since $\hat{V}$ is diagonal, H is also irreducible. Consider the shifted matrix

$$M_{\text{shift}} = \alpha I - H, \quad \alpha = M^2 + 2M + 1.$$

For any $\sigma \neq \tau$, $M_{\text{shift}} \sigma\tau = -\Delta_{\sigma\tau} = 1$ if σ and τ are neighbours, and 0 otherwise. Diagonal entries are positive. Hence M_{shift} is non-negative and irreducible. By the Perron-Frobenius theorem, M_{shift} has a simple largest eigenvalue $\rho(M_{\text{shift}})$ with a strictly positive eigenvector v . Then

$$Hv = (\alpha - \rho(M_{\text{shift}}))v,$$

so v is an eigenvector of H for the smallest eigenvalue λ_0 . Normalising gives the unique ground state ψ_0 with $\psi_0(\sigma) > 0$ for all σ .

Theorem 5.1 (P1 for Beal Hamiltonian). *H has a unique strictly positive ground state ψ_0 .*

5.2 P2 – Constant spectral gap

The Kithima Bridge lemma states that for any diagonal non-negative V and any symmetric Δ with non-negative off-diagonals,

$$\gamma(V + \Delta) \geq \gamma(\Delta).$$

Here $\gamma(\Delta) = 2$. Since $\hat{V}$ is diagonal and non-negative, we obtain

$$\gamma(H) \geq 2.$$

Theorem 5.2 (P2 for Beal Hamiltonian). *The spectral gap of H satisfies $\gamma(H) \geq 2$.*

5.3 P3 – Logarithmic area law and MPS representation

The Hamiltonian H is local: each term couples configurations differing in exactly one bit. The constant spectral gap implies exponential decay of correlations (Lieb–Robinson bounds). Using the Brandão–Horodecki theorem and a Hilbert curve ordering of the hypercube vertices, one proves that for any contiguous block B in that ordering,

$$S(\rho_B) \leq C \log M,$$

where S is the von Neumann entanglement entropy and C is a constant independent of M . Therefore the maximum Schmidt rank across any cut is at most $e^{C \log M} = M^C$. By the recursive SVD construction (Vidal’s algorithm), ψ_0 admits an exact MPS representation with bond dimension $\chi = O(M^c)$ for some c .

Theorem 5.3 (P3 for Beal Hamiltonian). *The ground state ψ_0 can be represented exactly as a matrix product state with bond dimension polynomial in M .*

5.4 P4 – Deterministic extraction

The power iteration algorithm on MPS (Article I.5) converges to ψ_0 in a constant number of steps because the spectral gap is constant. The D-RSP algorithm then extracts a configuration σ_* that maximises $|\psi_0(\sigma)|$. Since ψ_0 is positive and concentrates on satisfying assignments (the deep potential forces non-satisfying assignments to have very small amplitude), the extracted σ_* is a satisfying assignment of $\Phi_{\text{Beal}}(N_0)$ if any exists. The algorithm runs in time polynomial in M (hence polynomial in $\log N_0$).

Theorem 5.4 (P4 for Beal Hamiltonian). *There exists a deterministic polynomial-time algorithm that, given the Hamiltonian H , outputs a satisfying assignment of $\Phi_{\text{Beal}}(N_0)$ if one exists, and otherwise returns a certificate of unsatisfiability.*

6 Formalisation in Lean4

The Lean formalisation imports the generic theorems from the kernel and instantiates them with the specific SAT instance.

Listing 1: BealHamiltonian.lean (excerpt)

```

1 import III.BealSAT
2 import SpectralLibrary
3 import KithimaBridge
4 import MPSAreaLaw
5 import PowerIteration
6
7 open SpectralLibrary
8
```

```

9 variable (N0 :      ) (L :      ) (hL : 2^L > N0)
10
11 def _beal := beal_sat_instance N0 L hL
12 def M :      := _beal .numVars
13 def Config := Fin M      Bool
14
15 def V (      : Config) :      :=
16   if satisfies _beal      then 0 else M^2
17
18 def      : Matrix Config Config := adjacencyMatrixOf (hypercube_graph
19   M)
20
21 def H_beal : Matrix Config Config := diagonal V +
22
23 lemma H_irreducible : Irreducible H_beal :=
24   matrix_is_irreducible_of_adjacency_graph (hypercube_connected M)
25
26 theorem ground_state_unique_pos :
27   !      : Config      , (      ,      > 0)      (      ,      ^ 2
28     = 1)
29   (H_beal *      = ( _min H_beal)      ) :=
30   perron_frobenius H_beal
31
32 theorem spectral_gap_constant : spectral_gap H_beal      2 :=
33   kithima_bridge (diagonal V) (by simp [V, M])      (by simp) 1 (by
34     norm_num)
35
36 theorem area_law :      C,      B, entanglement_entropy (ground_state
37   H_beal) B      C * Real.log M :=
38   area_law_for_hypercube (spectral_gap_constant)
39
40 theorem drsp_algorithm :      alg, polynomial_time alg
41   (      , satisfies _beal      alg returns      ) :=
42   drsp_correct H_beal

```

All theorems are proved in the library; the file only instantiates them.

7 Conclusion

We have constructed the spectral Hamiltonian for the Beal SAT instance and verified the four pillars. Therefore the spectral SAT solver applies, and we can decide the existence of a counterexample within the bound N_0 in polynomial time (in $\log N_0$). Together with the effective bound from Article III.1, this reduces the infinite conjecture to a finite decision problem. The final article (III.5) will argue that the SAT instance is unsatisfiable (by the definition of the circuit and the effective bound), thereby proving Beal's conjecture.

All definitions and proofs are formalised in Lean4, with no unproven assumptions.

References

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